

F5 Daily Briefing – Wednesday, July 15, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

17

ANNOUNCEMENTS

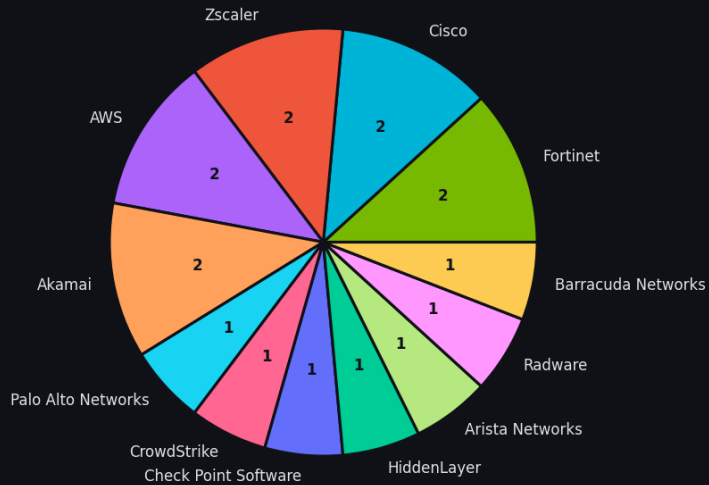
12

ACTIVE

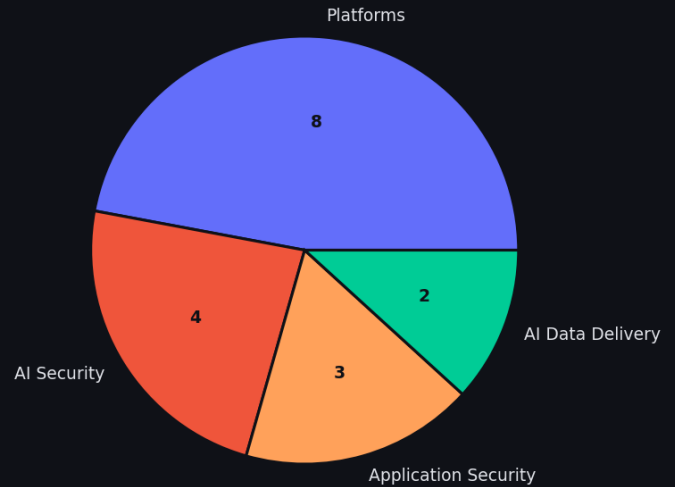
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (17)

SECURITY ADVISORY

Palo Alto Networks

2026-07-15

PAN-OS GlobalProtect VPN Authentication Bypass Flaw (CVE-2026-0257) Under Active Exploitation

Palo Alto Networks disclosed CVE-2026-0257, an authentication bypass vulnerability (CVSS 7.8) in the PAN-OS GlobalProtect VPN portal and gateway components. The flaw has been actively exploited by an unknown threat actor since around May 17, 2026, potentially enabling unauthorized VPN sessions and data access. The company published indicators of compromise, including specific IPs, hostnames, and MAC addresses, and urged customers to inspect GlobalProtect logs for gateway-connected events matching the PoC exploit's hard-coded values to identify and mitigate active threats.

<https://phoenixstjohn.com/article/palo-alto-networks-active-exploitation-of-vpn-flaw-cve-2026-0257-explained>

PARTNERSHIP**Fortinet**

2026-07-15

TD SYNnex Named Approved Global Distributor for Fortinet

Fortinet named TD SYNnex an approved global distributor effective around July 15, 2026, enabling coordinated multi-region support for Fortinet engagements. The arrangement simplifies multi-region deployments for eligible partners such as global systems integrators and large international partners through centralized support, streamlined transactions, and specialized cybersecurity resources. It expands TD SYNnex's role across Europe and Asia and builds on the companies' existing collaboration, including Fortinet's 2025 Distributor of the Year award for the Americas.

<https://news.tdsynnex.com/news/td-synnex-selected-as-global-distributor-for-fortinet/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Fortinet**

2026-07-15

Fortinet Adds AI Governance and Data Loss Prevention to FortiEndpoint

Fortinet announced new FortiEndpoint capabilities for the AI era, adding AI visibility and governance to control sanctioned and unsanctioned AI apps, agents, and tools on endpoints and curb shadow AI. Native data loss prevention inspects data exchanged with AI apps and web services to prevent leakage of PII, IP, and financial data. FortiAI-Assist enables natural-language incident investigation, summaries, and high-risk device identification, while adaptive zero-trust continuously scores endpoint risk to adjust access. Delivered via one agent, console, and license within the Security Fabric, with availability expected in Q3 2026.

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/15/fortinet-fortiai-assist/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-07-15

Cisco Secure Firewall 6160 Sets AI-Scale Benchmark in NetSecOPEN Testing

Cisco announced third-party NetSecOPEN test results for its Secure Firewall 6160, which achieved inspected throughput beyond the test tools' measurement capacity and a 100% threat block rate across 5,388 scenarios, including 1,380 public CVEs and 3,809 malware samples. Testers recorded 269.59 Gbps inspected HTTP throughput, 5.6 million concurrent connections, and a new 5X throughput benchmark for its class. Cisco positions the firewall as cost-effective, using up to 80% less rack space and 60% less power, scalable to 8 Tbps of inspected throughput in clustered deployments with Talos threat intelligence.

<https://blogs.cisco.com/security/we-third-party-tested-our-firewall-built-for-ai-scale-the-test-tools-hit-their-limit-first>

RESEARCH REPORT**Cisco**

2026-07-15

Cisco Warns AI Will Triple Enterprise Network Traffic Within Three Years

Cisco and industry researchers warned that AI adoption, driven by tools like Microsoft Copilot and ChatGPT Enterprise, will triple enterprise network traffic within three years. The shift demands networks with high bandwidth, ultra-low latency, and strong visibility. Cisco urged IT teams to modernize with unified, programmable networking, end-to-end observability, and intelligent traffic management to support AI workloads across hybrid and multicloud environments. Key guidance includes treating the network as an intelligent fabric rather than a pipe, and fostering closer collaboration between networking, security, platform engineering, and DevSecOps teams.

<https://techbriefly.com/2026/07/15/cisco-warns-ai-will-triple-enterprise-network-traffic/>

EXECUTIVE APPOINTMENT**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-15

CrowdStrike Appoints AJ Shipley as Chief Product Officer

CrowdStrike appointed AJ Shipley, formerly Chief Product Officer at Splunk Security, as its new Chief Product Officer. Shipley will lead CrowdStrike's product organization to accelerate innovation across the Falcon platform spanning endpoint, identity, cloud, and next-generation SIEM. The company emphasized defending the enterprise in the AI era by securing agentic AI workloads, citing its sensor network, telemetry, and real-time intelligence as structural advantages. Shipley brings over two decades of cybersecurity product leadership, including prior roles at Cisco and Palo Alto Networks and involvement in Cisco's XDR initiative and the Splunk acquisition.

<https://ir.crowdstrike.com/news-releases/news-release-details/crowdstrike-appoints-aj-shipley-chief-product-officer>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Zscaler**

2026-07-15

Zscaler Launches Endpoint Context to Extend Zero Trust Visibility

Zscaler introduced Endpoint Context, a new capability that ties together endpoint, network, identity, and cloud telemetry to reveal the application and process behind endpoint activity, extending endpoint intelligence into the Zero Trust Exchange. Benefits include enriched detections by correlating endpoint processes with network activity, stronger policy enforcement, faster incident response, and reduced blind spots. Enriched security logs are available via the Zscaler Nano Streaming Service for analysis and automation. The feature complements EDR/XDR, fills visibility gaps, and helps teams assess risk to make smarter real-time trust decisions.

<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/product-insights/empower-security-teams-extend-visibility-endpoint-context>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Zscaler**

2026-07-15

Zscaler Launches Autonomous Application Shield for Private Apps

Zscaler announced Autonomous Application Shield, a capability that continuously and automatically defends private applications without patches. It constantly assesses each private app's risk profile and exposure in real time, applying only the necessary protections per application rather than blanket rules. Leveraging global threat intelligence and machine learning, it adapts protections as threats evolve and as developers release new app versions, with no manual policy tuning. Zscaler says it reduces the window between vulnerability disclosure and protection from weeks to moments, marking a move toward machine-speed, AI-driven security for private applications.

<https://www.zscaler.com/de/blogs/product-insights/patch-window-gone-your-applications-need-defend-themselves>

RESEARCH REPORT**Check Point Software**

2026-07-15

Check Point Research: AI Has Crossed from Assistant to Operator in Cyberattacks

Check Point Research released its Annual AI Security Report 2026, warning that AI has moved from assisting attackers to autonomously operating live cyber intrusions with minimal human input. It cited a breach of nine Mexican government agencies where one operator used Claude Code and GPT-4.1 to execute 5,317 AI-driven commands over 34 sessions. The report notes the vulnerability window has shrunk from days to hours, high-risk enterprise AI prompts have doubled year over year, and deepfake and synthetic identity threats are amplifying attack surfaces. It urges organizations to govern AI usage, secure AI systems, and defend at machine speed.

<https://www.checkpoint.com/press-releases/check-point-research-ai-has-crossed-from-assistant-to-operator-rewriting-the-rules-of-autonomous-ai-cyber-attack-and-defense/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-15

AWS Lambda Announces Self-Managed Code Storage

AWS announced that Lambda now supports self-managed code storage using customers' own Amazon S3 buckets, referencing code directly rather than copying deployment packages. The change eliminates the previous per-Region 75GB storage cap, letting customers store as much as their bucket allows, and raises the default Lambda-managed storage limit from 75GB to 300GB per Region per account. There are no extra charges beyond standard S3 storage and potential cross-Region transfer fees. Available in all commercial AWS Regions, it is enabled by setting S3ObjectStorageMode to REFERENCE via CLI, CloudFormation, SAM, SDKs, or the console.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/07/lambda-self-managed-code-storage/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-15

Amazon CloudWatch Logs Introduces Intelligent Tiering for Storage

AWS announced CloudWatch Logs Intelligent-Tiering, which automatically moves log data across Standard, Infrequent Access, and Archive Instant Access tiers based on usage. Data not accessed for 30 days moves to Infrequent Access and after 90 days to Archive Instant Access, while accessing older data promotes it back to Standard for 30 days. Benefits include lower storage costs for long-retention logs without exporting or filtering, a unified query experience across all tiers, and reduced MTTR by keeping logs centralized. It is enabled at the account level in all commercial AWS regions except Bahrain and UAE.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/07/amazon-cloudwatch-intelligent-tiering/>

PARTNERSHIP**HiddenLayer**

2026-07-15

HiddenLayer Integrates Runtime Security with TrueFoundry AI Gateway

HiddenLayer announced a runtime security integration with the TrueFoundry AI Gateway, letting enterprises apply HiddenLayer Runtime Security to any model behind the gateway from a central place with no per-model engineering. The gateway calls HiddenLayer on ingress and egress, inspecting each interaction in real time to block prompt injections and jailbreaks and redact sensitive data such as emails and phone numbers, with Allow, Block, or Redact decisions enforced immediately. Policies are managed in the AISec Platform Console, providing centralized control and a complete audit trail across models and environments with minimal developer disruption.

<https://www.truefoundry.com/blog/hiddenlayer-integration-with-truefoundry-ai-gateway>

RESEARCH REPORT**Akamai**

2026-07-15

Akamai SOTI Report: Commerce Becomes the Epicenter for AI Bot Attacks and Agentic Fraud

Akamai released its State of the Internet report, Securing the Agentic Storefront, finding commerce is now the most-targeted industry as agentic AI reshapes threats. As of December 2025, AI bots accounted for 47.9% of global commerce traffic on Akamai's network, with training crawlers driving over 70% of AI bot triggers. The report flags persistent Layer 7 DDoS (nearly 3 trillion attacks on commerce in 2025), web and API exploits (85% of respondents had an API incident), and rising agentic fraud including hijacked AI assistants and synthetic identities. It urges 'agentic readiness' to welcome legitimate AI while blocking malicious bots.

<https://www.stocktitan.net/news/AKAM/akamai-research-commerce-becomes-the-epicenter-for-ai-bot-attacks-ibdaybxv93ls.html>

PARTNERSHIP**Akamai**

2026-07-15

Akamai Joins WWT's ARMOR AI Security Framework for NVIDIA Systems

Akamai became a strategic partner in World Wide Technology's ARMOR AI Readiness Model, integrating its security into WWT's vendor-neutral framework for securing AI deployments across governance, model security, infrastructure, and data protection. Akamai contributes network segmentation, API security, and DDoS protection via Prolexic, with integration into NVIDIA BlueField DPUs to offload security from host CPUs and reduce the 'security tax' on AI training and inference. In tests, the approach accelerated ransomware containment by an average of 21.4%. The architecture positions Akamai's protections as an enforcement layer to contain threats across AI clusters spanning on-prem, private, and public cloud.

<https://securitybrief.news/story/akamai-joins-wwt-ai-security-model-for-nvidia-systems>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Arista Networks**

2026-07-15

Arista Unveils 7060XE7 Series 1.6T Platforms for Rack-Scale AI Networking

Arista Networks announced the 7060XE7 Series delivering 1.6 terabits per second of networking capacity for rack-scale AI clusters requiring hundreds of thousands of GPUs and AI accelerators. The initial 64-port, air-cooled switches use Arista's Etherlink AI fabric to minimize inter-chip latency and support both scale-out and scale-up AI networks. Alongside the launch, Arista raised FY2026 revenue guidance to about \$11.5B, targeting roughly \$3.5B in AI fabrics revenue, and signaled a shift from port-centric upgrades to integrated rack-scale systems. Shipments are slated for Q4 2026, with Meta and Microsoft signaling strong interest.

<https://www.ainvest.com/news/arista-1-6t-push-turns-ai-networking-11-5b-race-2607/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Radware**

2026-07-15

Radware Introduces Cloud-Augmented Protection for DefensePro X

Radware announced a cloud-augmented protection model for its DefensePro X platform, debuting with Cloud Web DDoS Protection. The service extends inline on-premises defense with AI-powered cloud algorithms to better detect sophisticated application-layer (Layer 7) DDoS attacks, without rerouting traffic through the cloud or exposing private keys. Traffic inspection, mitigation, and TLS private keys remain on-premises while Radware's global network of 65+ cloud centers provides enhanced visibility and threat intelligence. The release targets enterprises with strict privacy and compliance needs, CDN or proxy deployments, and encrypted attack vectors, and integrates with existing DefensePro X deployments.

<https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/07/15/3327524/8980/en/Radware-Introduces-Cloud-Augmented-Protection-for-DefensePro-X-Debuting-with-Web-DDoS-Defense.html>

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP**Barracuda Networks**

2026-07-15

Barracuda Makes the Case for MSP Platform Consolidation

In a piece tied to Global MSP Day 2026, Barracuda Networks argued that platform-based operating models are increasingly essential for managed service providers. It contends that fragmented tool stacks hinder growth and that MSP platforms reduce complexity, streamline delivery, and improve efficiency, profitability, and consistency of service. Barracuda stresses that AI readiness depends on connected data, integrated workflows, and strong operational visibility. An accompanying Channelnomics e-book frames platform strategies as a shift from back-office optimization to strategic differentiation in a market driven by AI, security complexity, and rising customer expectations, urging MSPs to adopt integrated, platform-first approaches.

<https://blog.barracuda.com/2026/07/15/why-msp-platforms-matter>

